

Critical play

By C.G.S.Narayanan

A move by, white or black, is called critical move when it passes over a square (known as critical square) with the result that any other piece moving subsequently to that square will produce an interference. The two mover below is a typical example in critical and anti-critical play.

M.Barulin,G.Golubev,A.P.Guliev,Lev Loshinsky,E.Umnov and V.I.Schiff '64'1932 (in memorium L.Isaev)



Mate in two moves

The **key 1.Rb5!** threatens 2.Ne4 which simultaneously shuts off the BQ and BRe2 from the line b5-h5. Black defends by playing these two pieces on to or beyond that line, so that Ne4 becomes ineffective as a shut off. Such defences are anti-critical with respect to e4. 1...Qd5 allows 2.Bg4. 1...Qa8 however prevents by pinning the Bc8 and by playing to a8 BQ crosses not only e4 but also a second critical square b7. White is able to play 2.Nb7 again shutting off BQ but this time on the other side of the fifth rank. Note that BR is pinned. An analogous pair of defences is made by this rook. 1...Re5 2.Nxf4; 1...Rxe7 crosses the second critical square, this time e6 met by shut off 2.Ne6.

The second problem below shows critical play by white piece as tries with black gaining advantage from crossing over the critical square. Try 1.Rg2? 1..Rxf4! because (2.Ng4? cannot played). 1.Rxd5? 1...Bxf4! (2.Be5?); 1.Rg4? 1...Rh5! (2.Ng4?); 1.Re5 ? 1...Bb6! (2.Be5?) **Key 1.Rh5!** (2.Qxh4)

E.Visserman

3 prize, Schach 1959



Mate in two moves

White plays his rook to a square where it neither crosses nor blocks a square needed for mating.

Two-mover Below is a Meredith showing critical tries by a single white bishop crossing critical squares in all directions.

WWH.Ahues & A.Volkman

I prize, Dormund Hombruch

Barop 1951



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Goethart unpin': **1.Kb3!** waiting 1...d5 2.Nc3; 1...Ne2 2.Nc1 1...N any 2.Rxf1

Readers may send in their queries to cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com